

F5 Daily Briefing — Tuesday, May 19, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

17

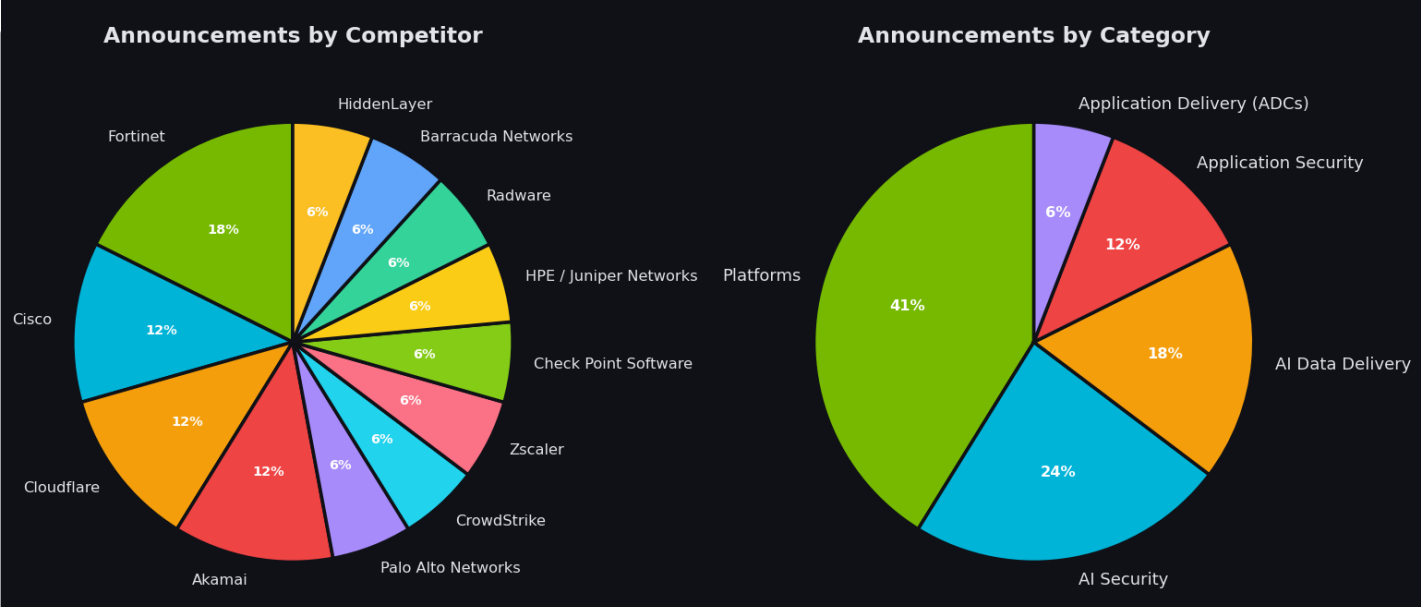
ANNOUNCEMENTS

12

ACTIVE

5

ACTIVE CATEGORIES



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (17)

CORPORATE

Akamai

2026-05-19

Akamai Launches \$2.6 Billion Convertible Bond Offering to Fund Cloud Infrastructure Expansion

Akamai launched a \$2.6 billion bond offering to fund growth in its Cloud Infrastructure Services business. The structure includes two tranches of \$1.3 billion each in zero-percent senior convertible notes, due 2030 and 2032 respectively, with initial purchasers eligible to acquire an additional \$200 million per tranche. Proceeds will be used to expand Akamai's global cloud footprint, fund general corporate purposes, repay convertible note hedge transactions, and allocate roughly \$350 million for share repurchases. The move follows Akamai's \$1.8 billion seven-year cloud contract with Anthropic and plans to deploy NVIDIA-based AI hardware globally.

Source: <https://www.datacenterdynamics.com/en/news/akamai-launches-26bn-bond-offering/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Akamai**

2026-05-19

Akamai Launches AI Brand Presence to Optimize Content for Agentic Search

Akamai introduced AI Brand Presence, a new offering that helps organizations optimize content for AI search and agentic traffic. The product automatically translates and reformats website content for LLM and AI-agent retrieval, monitors bot activity, and applies edge security. In an internal pilot on its own site, Akamai cut data loads by 99%, saw 85% more AI citations, a 364% boost in overall brand presence, and 133% growth in ChatGPT mentions versus competitors. AI bot traffic is up over 300% year-over-year. The solution launches in limited availability with phased rollout to North American customers.

Source: <https://www.barchart.com/story/news/2010063/akamai-ai-brand-presence-optimizes-content-and-raises-visibility-in-agentic-search>

PARTNERSHIP**Barracuda Networks**

2026-05-19

Barracuda Partners with CyberCert to Simplify SMB1001 Cyber Certification for ANZ SMEs

Barracuda Networks announced a partnership with CyberCert to deliver SMB1001 compliance for small businesses across Australia and New Zealand via BarracudaONE. The initiative targets MSPs and bundles SMB1001-certified product packages spanning email security, data protection and recovery, network and remote access protection, and managed EDR through existing MSP relationships. Sponsored CyberCert Certification Credits are available to reduce entry costs, with credits awarded as pilots reach certification. The goal is to provide an affordable, streamlined path to formal cybersecurity certification for ANZ SMBs while leveraging MSP delivery to reduce cost and operational burden.

Source: <https://channellife.co.nz/story/barracuda-cybercert-ease-smb1001-compliance-for-smes>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Check Point Software**

2026-05-19

Check Point Launches Agentic Network Security Orchestration Platform, Acquires Deepchecks

Check Point launched its Agentic Network Security Orchestration Platform, using AI agents and a Network Knowledge Graph to automate security operations. The platform translates business intent into firewall rules, identifies over-permissive configurations, diagnoses network issues, and maintains compliance with DORA, PCI-DSS, and NIST. Core capabilities include Intent-to-Policy, Zero Trust Policy Tightening, Autonomous Troubleshooting, and Continuous Compliance, with Policy Auditor, Policy Insights, and AI Assist available now and Playblocks Agents in early access. To accelerate the roadmap, Check Point also announced acquiring Deepchecks' team and IP for AI evaluation, observability, and monitoring.

Source: <https://ca.investing.com/news/stock-market-news/check-point-launches-aidriven-network-security-platform-93CH-4648554>

PRODUCT UPDATE**Cisco**

2026-05-19

Cisco Duo Expands Identity Risk Visibility with Cisco Foundation AI

Cisco announced that Cisco Identity Intelligence is now the first Cisco product powered end-to-end by Cisco Foundation AI, a purpose-built model tuned for security and identity. The update delivers clearer, more actionable identity insights, including a weekly admin digest that surfaces anomalies and improves identity hygiene. Used by more than 2,000 customers, the enhancement requires no user changes while improving prioritization and recommendations. Cisco emphasized stronger security, data governance, and regional priorities for industries such as government, finance, and energy across the Middle East.

Source: <https://www.zawya.com/en/press-release/companies-news/cisco-duo-expands-identity-risk-visibility-with-cisco-foundation-ai-iab8px1b>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Cisco

2026-05-19

Cisco Unveils Universal Quantum Switch for Scalable Quantum Networks

Cisco announced the Universal Quantum Switch, the first research prototype that routes quantum information between major encoding modalities without destroying qubits. Using a Cisco-patented quantum-modality conversion engine, the device preserves quantum states at room temperature over existing telecom fiber. Validated with polarization encoding, it integrates support for time-bin and frequency-bin encoding for future validation. Performance includes nanosecond switching, sub-1W power consumption, and fidelity/entanglement degradation averaging $\leq 4\%$. The milestone advances Cisco's full-stack quantum networking program, enabling interoperable, vendor-agnostic quantum networks and scalable distributed quantum computing.

Source: <https://www.zawya.com/en/press-release/companies-news/cisco-unveils-universal-quantum-switch-paving-the-way-for-scalable-quantum-networks-na3r7iol>

PRODUCT UPDATE

Cloudflare

2026-05-19

Cloudflare Adds Event Subscriptions for Artifacts Lifecycle Events

Cloudflare introduced event subscriptions for Artifacts lifecycle events, enabling developers to receive notifications for repository changes and consume them via a Worker for commit-driven automation. Available account-level events include repo.created, repo.deleted, repo.forked, and repo.imported; repository-level events cover pushed, cloned, and fetched. Use cases span running workflows when repos are created or imported, triggering builds and deployments on agent pushes, and invoking review agents on every push. The capability deepens Cloudflare's developer platform automation and integrates Artifacts more tightly into CI/CD and agentic workflows.

Source: <https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-05-19-event-subscriptions/>

PARTNERSHIP

Cloudflare

2026-05-19

Cloudflare Brings Secure, Scalable Sandboxes to Anthropic's Claude Managed Agents

Cloudflare and Anthropic announced Cloudflare Environments for Claude Managed Agents. The integration runs core Claude agent loops on Anthropic's platform while Cloudflare provides global execution, secure connections, and custom tool calls via its Workers platform. Developers get a choice of Linux microVMs or V8 Isolates for rapid boot and cost-effective scaling, post-quantum-ready encryption with Cloudflare Mesh for private connectivity, native observability with audit trails and session recordings, and extensible custom-tool frameworks. The collaboration enables AI agent workloads to scale from prototype to millions of users with built-in security and compliance controls.

Source: <https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260519690935/en/Cloudflare-Brings-Secure-Scalable-Sandboxes-to-Claude-Managed-Agents>

PARTNERSHIP

CrowdStrike

2026-05-19

CrowdStrike and SVA Partner to Power Next Phase of Cybersecurity Growth in Germany

CrowdStrike announced a strategic partnership with SVA System Vertrieb Alexander GmbH to bring the CrowdStrike Falcon platform to public sector, enterprise, and mid-market customers across Germany. The collaboration aims to standardize on Falcon to reduce tool sprawl, lower costs, and enhance breach prevention. SVA will handle architecture design, deployment, and managed services, with joint efforts to expand via AWS Marketplace, STACKIT, and Google Cloud Marketplace to accelerate Falcon adoption. The agreement deepens CrowdStrike's European platform consolidation strategy and broadens regional reach for its unified cybersecurity platform.

Source: https://markets.ft.com/data/announce/detail?dockey=600-202605200200BIZWIRE_USPRX___20260519_BW951335-1

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Fortinet**

2026-05-19

Fortinet Advances Security Operations Platform with Unified SOC, Agentic AI, and FortiSOC Preview

At Fortinet Accelerate 2026, Fortinet unveiled major Security Operations Platform enhancements including agentic AI workflows, expanded FortiAI, and a preview of FortiSOC, a cloud-delivered service unifying FortiAnalyzer, FortiSIEM, FortiSOAR, and FortiTIP. New automated alert triage, investigation, and threat hunting are powered by FortiAI agents. FortiEndpoint adds unified EPP, EDR, DLP, ZTNA/SASE data protection, and AI-driven application control in a single agent. Enhanced FortiGuard managed services and cross-platform telemetry round out a single architecture designed to reduce complexity and defend against AI-driven threats at scale.

Source: <http://fortinet.com/corporate/about-us/newsroom/press-releases/2026/fortinet-advances-its-security-operations-platform-with-unified-soc-agentic-ai-and-expanded-endpoint-security>

PRODUCT UPDATE**Fortinet**

2026-05-19

Fortinet Expands FortiCNAPP with Network, Data, and Unified Risk Context

Fortinet expanded FortiCNAPP cloud risk management with unified network, data, and runtime context. New capabilities correlate network enforcement, data sensitivity, vulnerabilities, DSPM, and runtime behavior in a single workflow. Built-in DSPM identifies sensitive data and access patterns without exporting data, while runtime-informed prioritization validates exploitable code paths to distinguish real threats from theoretical findings. Business-impact prioritization elevates risks involving sensitive data. The update consolidates signals into one actionable view, reducing tool sprawl and accelerating remediation across multi-cloud environments.

Source: <https://blog.fortinet.com/corporate/about-us/newsroom/press-releases/2026/fortinet-expands-forticnapp-cloud-risk-management-with-network-data-and-unified-risk-context>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Fortinet**

2026-05-19

Fortinet Introduces FortiOS 8.0 with Secure AI Controls, Fabric-Based AI Agents, and Quantum-Safe Networking

Fortinet introduced FortiOS 8.0 as part of its Secure Networking initiative at Accelerate 2026. The release delivers AI-driven security, secure AI controls, fabric-based AI agents, next-generation SASE, simplified SD-WAN, and quantum-safe capabilities. The update aims to consolidate architectures, embed future-ready security directly into the network, and ensure consistent protection and performance across hybrid environments. FortiOS 8.0 supports digital transformation, AI adoption, and long-term resilience within the Fortinet Security Fabric, providing unified policy enforcement and operational efficiency across self-managed, cloud, and managed deployments.

Source: <http://fortinet.com/corporate/about-us/newsroom/press-releases/2026/fortinet-introduces-fortios-8-expand-secure-networking-with-secure-ai-controls-fabric-based-ai-agents-flexible-sase-and-simplified-sdwan>

HPE Debuts First Juniper-Aruba Collaboration: Self-Driving Wi-Fi with Unified Management

HPE announced its first Juniper-Aruba collaboration delivering unified Wi-Fi solutions that allow administrators to manage access points via Aruba Central or Mist while gaining new self-driving AI features. Capabilities include dynamic RF environment scanning that avoids priority frequencies such as military bands, dynamic capacity optimization during large events to preserve connection quality, and automated detection plus remediation of VLAN mismatches and network rebuilds. The cloud-based self-driving layer draws on HPE, Juniper, and Marvis AI data. HPE emphasized blending Aruba and Juniper offerings without forcing brand migration while reducing manual admin work.

Source: <https://uk.headtopics.com/news/hpe-drops-first-juniper-x-aruba-collab-self-driving-wi-fi-83545281>

HiddenLayer Discloses Unpatched ChromaDB Pre-Auth RCE Vulnerability (ChromaToast)

HiddenLayer disclosed an unpatched pre-authentication remote code execution vulnerability in ChromaDB, tracked as CVE-2026-45829 and nicknamed ChromaToast. An unauthenticated attacker can supply a crafted HuggingFace model to trigger RCE, gaining shell access and full control over the server process, including API keys, environment variables, secrets, and disk files. The flaw stems from the server trusting client-supplied model identifiers before authentication and can be triggered via collection creation without credentials. All ChromaDB versions since 1.0.0 are affected; HiddenLayer estimates 73% of internet-exposed deployments are vulnerable. As of ChromaDB 1.5.8, no patches have been applied.

Source: <https://www.securityweek.com/unpatched-chromadb-vulnerability-can-lead-to-server-takeover/>

What's New in Cortex (May '26): Agentic SOC and Identity-Aware Response

Palo Alto Networks rolled out a major Cortex portfolio refresh featuring Cortex XSIAM 3.5 with an Agentic SOC, proactive AI agents, stronger governance, and Idira Endpoint Privilege Manager integration for identity-aware incident response. Cortex XDR 5.1 adds Kernel Monitoring Defense for macOS, expanded Java malware protection across Windows and Linux, and new file integrity capabilities. Advanced Email Security gains an Email Investigation Agent, and Cortex Exposure Management plus Xpanse 2.12/2.13 deliver faster validation, broader scanning, and streamlined ASM workflows. The release emphasizes autonomous, identity-aware response and cross-platform protection.

Source: <https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/security-operations/whats-new-in-cortex-may-26/>

Radware Announces New \$80 Million Share Repurchase Plan

Radware announced a new share repurchase program authorized by its board. The 2026 Plan permits buying back up to \$80 million of issued and outstanding ordinary shares through open market purchases, privately negotiated transactions, or other permissible methods. The authorization expires March 15, 2027. Purchases will follow U.S. securities laws, including Rule 10b-18 and potentially Rule 10b5-1 plans, alongside Israeli law. Radware noted there is no obligation to repurchase a specific number of shares and the program can be suspended or terminated at management's discretion based on market conditions and capital allocation priorities.

Source: <http://www.radware.com/newsevents/pressreleases/2026/radware-announces-new-80-million-share-repurchase-plan/>

Zscaler Launches Project AI-Guardian Security Program with Global System Integrators

Zscaler unveiled Project AI-Guardian, a new AI security initiative pairing its Zero Trust framework with consulting from global system integrators including Cognizant, EY, HCL, Infosys, TCS, and Wipro. Partners use Zscaler's AI Protect portfolio—AI Asset Management, Secure Access to AI, and Secure AI Infrastructure and Apps—to deliver visibility, usage controls, and continuous monitoring of enterprise AI systems. AI Asset Management identifies unauthorized AI apps, maps data connections, and assesses risks across endpoints, network traffic, SaaS, cloud services, and code repositories. The program extends Zero Trust principles to AI assets at enterprise scale.

Source: <https://za.investing.com/news/stock-market-news/zscaler-launches-ai-security-program-with-system-integrators-93CH-4289835>